

The Extra-Ordinary

AYUSHMANN KHURRANA, 37

Actor

"If you can do value education through your cinema, I think it's great. You give back something to society. I like to do such films that make people uncomfortable"

AYUSHMANN KHURRANA
Aaj Tak Agenda, 2021

Whenever Hindi filmmakers have looked to deliver a social message to their audience through their films, there's one actor they know they can count on—Ayushmann Khurrana. Few would have predicted a former *MTV Roadies* winner to take on this responsibility. A rom-com with gay men (*Shubh Mangal Zyada Saavdhan*); normalising a relationship with a trans woman (*Chandigarh Kare Aashiqui*); a protagonist with a high sperm count (*Vicky Donor*); or one with diminishing hair (*Bala*)—Khurrana's trump card is his ability to make heroes out of ordinary men.

Khurrana, though, is not content being pigeonholed. His last few films—*Andhadhun*, *Article 15*, *Gulabo Sitabo*—are proof. He has been vocal about his desire to do an action film. By championing progressive ideas and dabbling in different genres, Khurrana has emerged as an actor whose legacy is stamped in the originality and diversity of his work. ■

–Suhani Singh

FIELD WORK Khurrana, who has played cricket at district level, has said that he would like to play Virat Kohli on screen

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